Aditi Choudhary

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Education

University of Georgia, Athens, GA – M.A. Economics, 2024; Ph.D. Economics, Expected May 2027
McGill University, Montreal, QC – M.A. Economics, 2018
University of Delhi, Delhi – B.A. (Hons.) Economics, 2017

Research Interests

Development Economics, Labor Economics, Law and Economics

Working Papers

When Colleges Come Closer: The Effects of Local Higher Education Expansion on Educational Outcomes in India *(Job Market Paper)* [PDF]

Abstract: This paper evaluates the impact of new public colleges opened in underserved districts under a national higher education policy in India. I use Periodic Labour Force Survey data and a staggered difference-in-differences design. A local college increases schooling by 0.63 years, and by 0.84–0.88 years for students from disadvantaged caste groups. I also find suggestive evidence that college opening delays marriage among younger women.

Impact of Sexual and Reproductive Health Education on Adolescent Well-being *(Working Paper)* [PDF]

Abstract: This paper evaluates the impact of a national peer education program in India on adolescents' HIV knowledge, contraceptive use, and attitudes toward gender-based violence. I use National Family Health Survey data and a difference-in-differences design. The program increases HIV awareness by 11.7 percentage points and modern contraceptive use by 2.3 percentage points.

How Common are Romeos and Juliets? Evidence from Indian Court Cases, with Laura Zimmermann *(Work in Progress)*

Abstract: We study how the design of sexual assault law shapes the composition of the cases that courts process. Using a large language model and a codebook validated against human coding, we classify the near-universe of Delhi High Court sexual assault judgments from 2006 to 2023. About one fifth of cases involve consensual relationships, elopements or disputed promises of marriage, and parents rather than the woman are the complainants of record in over a third. Comparing cases governed by the same law but decided before and after 2013, when a high-profile case triggered a major reform, we find that courts became more skeptical rather than more punitive where they had room for judgment.

Labor Law Changes and Their Effect on Women's Work in India *(Work in Progress)*

National Lok Adalat: Solution for Clearing Backlogs in Subordinate Courts of India? *(Master's Paper, McGill University, 2018)*

Conference Presentations

- Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL – 2025; Houston, TX – 2026 (upcoming)
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, Boston, MA – 2026
- Annual SEEDS Conference, Georgia Tech, Atlanta, GA – 2026
- Annual Conference of the American Society of Health Economists, Minneapolis, MN – 2026
- Economics Seminar, John Munro Godfrey, Sr. Department of Economics, University of Georgia – 2024, 2025

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Best Second Year Paper Award, John Munro Godfrey, Sr. Department of Economics, University of Georgia – 2025
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Center for Teaching and Learning, University of Georgia – 2025–26
E T Comer Scholarship, Terry College of Business, University of Georgia – 2022–Present
Graduate Assistantship, University of Georgia – 2022–Present

Professional Experience

Graduate Research Assistant: Laura Zimmermann, University of Georgia – 2024–Present
Researcher: Institute for Competitiveness, India – 2019–2020.
Conducted quantitative policy research and authored policy notes and white papers.
Media: "Budget 2020: The Need for Gender Budgeting," *The Economic Times* – 2020
Affiliations: Mentee, Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics (AMIE), Cohort 2025–2026

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record, University of Georgia:

- ECON 2106: Principles of Microeconomics – 2025

Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia:

- ECON 4200: Economic Growth and Development – 2022, 2023, 2025, 2026
- ECON 2105: Principles of Macroeconomics – 2025
- ECON 2106: Principles of Microeconomics – 2023
- ECON 4010: Intermediate Microeconomics – 2023
- INTL 4320: Politics of Development – 2022

Teaching Assistant, McGill University:

- ECON 230D2: Microeconomic Theory – 2018

Skills

Programming: Python, R, Stata, MATLAB
Tools: Tableau, Git, LaTeX
Methods: Causal inference (difference-in-differences and event studies, IV, RDD), program evaluation, survey and administrative data analysis, text classification and validation using large language models

Dissertation Committee / References

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